

President Trump Participates in a Press Conference

Short Version for English Learners | 5000-word level | July 8, 2026

1. What Happened?

President Donald Trump spoke to reporters after a NATO summit in Ankara, Türkiye. The official White House video is about 40 minutes long. This short version is based on the available YouTube auto-generated captions, so it is useful for listening practice but not an official word-for-word transcript.

- Main setting: a press conference after the NATO summit.
- Main topics: NATO defense spending, U.S. factories, Iran, communism, Türkiye, and the F-35 airplane.
- Language style: informal, repeated words, short answers, strong opinions, and many numbers.

Very Short Summary

The speaker said NATO countries should spend more on defense and buy more American-made equipment. He said the United States was respected again. Reporters asked about Iran, communism, oil, European allies, Türkiye, and the F-35 program. A useful study point is the difference between policy words, such as defense and alliance, and emotional words, such as great, terrible, dangerous, and crazy.

Study Goal

Do not try to learn every word. First, understand the event, the repeated topics, and the speaker's main claims. Then use the transcript to practice listening for dates, numbers, countries, and verbs like will, might, want, need, and think.

2. Key Listening Excerpts

Excerpt A: NATO and defense spending

[03:39] "We achieved an unprecedented agreement to increase the annual defense spending ... from 2% to 5% of GDP."

Plain English: He says NATO members agreed to spend more money on defense. Listen for numbers: two percent, five percent, GDP.

Excerpt B: American-made equipment

[07:14] "They all want American-made equipment ... the Patriots and the Tomahawks ... are considered to be the best."

Plain English: He says other countries want weapons made in the United States. Useful phrase: American-made means made in America.

Excerpt C: Communism question

[25:21] A reporter asks about "the dangers of communism" and people who may not understand "how close communism has come to home."

Plain English: The reporter asks for a message to people living under communist or socialist systems, and also to people in democracies.

[26:04] "Communism is a disaster ... it has never worked and it is not going to work."

Plain English: The answer uses very strong judgment words. Notice the repeated pattern: it has never worked; it is not going to work.

Excerpt D: Türkiye and the F-35

[38:28] "They are talking about the F-35 airplane ... I have not totally made up my mind."

Plain English: He says the F-35 issue is still not finally decided. This is a good example of cautious language: not totally made up my mind.

3. Vocabulary for 5000-Word Learners

Word	Simple meaning	Example
summit	a meeting of leaders	The NATO summit was in Ankara.
alliance	countries working together	NATO is a military alliance.
defense	protection from attack	They talked about defense spending.
target	a goal or number to reach	The spending target was five percent.
equipment	tools or machines for a job	The speaker praised U.S. military equipment.
factory / plant	a place that makes products	He said more plants were being built.
tariff	a tax on imported goods	Tariffs were linked to jobs and factories.
communism	a political system opposed in the answer	The reporter asked about communism.
socialism	a political idea discussed with communism	He warned about socialism.
relationship	how people or countries are connected	He described ties with Turkey.
decision	a choice after thinking	He said no final F-35 decision was made.

Useful Sentence Patterns

- We need to + verb: We need to produce it faster.
- I think + sentence: I think they are making progress.
- It is going to + verb: It is going to happen very fast.
- not sure / not totally: I am not sure I want to make a deal.
- because of + noun: That is because of the tariffs.

Listening Tip

Auto captions often miss names and technical words. For example, company names, place names, and military terms may be wrong. When you hear an important name, pause the video and check another source.

4. Practice Page

A. Check Your Understanding

- Where did the press conference happen?
- What defense spending number did the speaker mention?
- Which reporter asked about communism?
- What airplane program did the Turkish reporter ask about?

B. Short Answers

- In one sentence, explain what NATO is.
- In one sentence, explain what a tariff is.
- Write two strong opinion words from the speech.

C. Speaking Practice

Use these sentence frames. Speak slowly and clearly.

- The main topic of the press conference was ____.
- One difficult word for me was ____, which means ____.
- The speaker sounded ____ because he used words like ____.
- I want to check the transcript because ____.

D. Source and Caution

Source video: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9JYvcEVlu3s>. Official White House video page:

<https://www.whitehouse.gov/videos/president-trump-participates-in-a-press-conference-jul-8-2026/>. This short PDF is based on auto-generated captions, so it should be checked against the video before quotation or serious research use.